Henri Arno

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Research Profile

PhD candidate at Ghent University working on causal machine learning for data-driven decision support. My research interests include causal inference, treatment effect estimation and policy learning, with applications in healthcare and business.

Education

Interdisciplinary PhD in Computer Science Engineering and Business Economics
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
2021 – present
Supervisors: prof. Thomas Demeester, prof. Klaas Mulier, and prof. Joke Baeck

Master of Science in Business Engineering: Data Analytics
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
2019 – 2021
Summa cum laude (percentile 95)

Bachelor of Science in Business Engineering
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
2016 – 2019

Academic Experience

PhD Candidate – FWO Fellow
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Nov 2023 – present
Supervisors: prof. Thomas Demeester, prof. Klaas Mulier, and prof. Joke Baeck
Research in causal machine learning for data-driven decision support
Funded by an FWO PhD Fellowship Fundamental Research

Visiting Researcher
Causal Machine Learning Lab, Institute of AI in Management
Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU), Munich, Germany
Sep 2025 – Dec 2025
Hosted by prof. Stefan Feuerriegel
Funded by an FWO Grant for a Long Stay Abroad

PhD Candidate – Interdisciplinary Research Project
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Sep 2021 – Oct 2023
Research on business failure prediction to support decision-making in commercial courts
Funded through an FWO research project led by prof. Joke Baeck

Research Projects

Causal Machine Learning for Data-Driven Decision Support (2023 – present)
Research on treatment effect estimation, ranking, and policy learning from observational data, with applications in healthcare and business.
Selected outputs: International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026), Machine Learning for Healthcare (MLHC 2026), NeurIPS Causal Representation Learning Workshop (2024).

Business Failure Prediction and Judicial Decision Support (2021 – 2023)
Interdisciplinary research on multimodal business failure prediction and AI-supported decision-making in collaboration with Belgian commercial courts.
Selected outputs: Annals of Operations Research (2025), European Insolvency and Restructuring Journal (2025), FinTech and Natural Language Processing Workshops (2022, 2023).

Grants and Fellowships

FWO PhD Fellowship Fundamental Research
Research Foundation Flanders (FWO)
Nov 2023 **–** Nov 2027
Panel: Science and Technology **–** Computer Science and Information Technology

FWO Grant for a Long Stay Abroad
Research Foundation Flanders (FWO)
Sep 2025 **–** Dec 2025
Funding for a three-month research stay at LMU Munich

CWO Faculty Mobility and Sabbatical Fund
Ghent University, Faculty Committee for Scientific Research (CWO)
July 2026
Travel support for participation at ICML 2026

Teaching and Supervision

Master's Dissertation Supervision
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Supervised 12 master's dissertations
- 8 students in Business Engineering
- 4 students in Computer Science Engineering

Teaching Assistance
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Assisted with grading, lab sessions, and course-related support for:
- *Machine-Learning Based Natural Language Processing*
- *Topics in Advanced Corporate Finance*
- *Financial Modelling*

Guest Lectures
Ghent University and KU Leuven, Belgium
Delivered guest lectures on the business failure prediction project to law students:
- *Introduction to Artificial Intelligence Technology* (KU Leuven)
- *Law and Economics* (Ghent University)

Honours and Distinctions

Quetelet Colleges Honours Programme
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
2017 – 2019
Selective extracurricular university-wide honours programme

Languages and Skills

Languages
Dutch: native
English: excellent
French: intermediate

Technical skills
Programming languages: Python, R, Java
Machine learning frameworks: PyTorch, scikit-learn
Other: Git, Bash, Linux, LaTeX